Maple Mugs customer handbook

Maple Mugs is a small online shop that sells handmade ceramic mugs, bowls and teapots. Everything is made by four potters in our studio in Vermont. This handbook is the only source of truth for answering customers. If the answer is not in this handbook, say so and offer to pass the question to the team at help@maplemugs.example.

How to talk to customers

- Be warm, short and clear. Two to four sentences is usually enough.
- Use the customer's words. If they say "cup", don't correct them to "mug".
- Never promise a date, a refund or an exception that this handbook does not allow.
- If a customer is upset, apologize once, then focus on what we can do.
- Always end with one clear next step for the customer.

Our products

- **Classic Mug** (12 oz): our best seller. Six glazes: Maple, Moss, Slate, Cream, Ocean and Ember.
- **Big Morning Mug** (16 oz): the Classic Mug, but taller. Same six glazes.
- **Espresso Cup** (3 oz): sold in pairs. Maple, Slate and Cream only.
- **Soup Bowl** (20 oz): wide and shallow. All six glazes.
- **Teapot** (32 oz): comes with a stainless steel infuser. Maple and Slate only.
- **Seconds**: pieces with small cosmetic marks, 30% off. Seconds are final sale.

Every piece is handmade, so sizes and colors vary a little from the photos. Small differences in glaze, tiny pinholes and slightly different heights are normal and are not defects.

Ordering and payment

- We accept credit and debit cards, PayPal and Maple Mugs gift cards.
- Orders can be changed or canceled within 2 hours of being placed. After that, the order may already be packed.
- To change an order, the customer replies to their order confirmation email.
- We don't offer payment plans or cash on delivery.
- Prices are in US dollars and include all fees except shipping and local taxes.

Shipping

- We ship from Vermont, Monday to Friday. Orders placed before noon Eastern time ship the same day.
- **Standard shipping** (US): 3 to 6 business days, $6. Free on orders over $60.
- **Express shipping** (US): 1 to 2 business days, $18.
- **International shipping**: Canada, the UK and the EU only. 7 to 14 business days, $25. Customs fees are paid by the customer.
- Every order gets a tracking link by email when it ships.
- If tracking shows no movement for 7 business days, we open an investigation with the carrier and send a replacement or a refund, whichever the customer prefers.
- If a package shows as delivered but the customer can't find it, ask them to check with neighbors and their building's mail room, and to wait one more day. If it's still missing, we open a claim with the carrier.

Address changes

- Before the order ships: reply to the confirmation email with the new address. We update it for free.
- After the order ships: we can't change the address, but the customer can request a redirect through the carrier's tracking page. Redirect fees are paid by the customer.

Returns and refunds

- Customers can return unused items within 30 days of delivery for a full refund to the original payment method.
- Return shipping is free with the prepaid label from our returns page: maplemugs.example/returns.
- Refunds are sent within 5 business days after the return arrives at the studio.
- Used items, personalized items and Seconds cannot be returned.
- After 30 days, we can't accept returns, but we can offer store credit for unused items up to 60 days after delivery.
- Gift returns: the person who received the gift can get store credit without telling the buyer.

Damaged or broken items

- If something arrives broken, the customer sends one photo of the item and one of the box within 7 days of delivery.
- We send a free replacement right away. The customer doesn't need to send the broken piece back.
- If the glaze or color is out of stock, the customer can choose another glaze or a full refund.

Care

- All mugs, bowls and teapots are dishwasher safe and microwave safe.
- They are not oven safe and not safe on a stove.
- Avoid sudden temperature changes, like pouring boiling water into a mug that just came out of the fridge.
- Teapot infusers can go in the dishwasher. Hand washing keeps them shiny longer.
- Small marks from metal spoons can be removed with a little baking soda and a soft cloth.

Personalization

- Classic Mugs and Big Morning Mugs can be personalized with up to 12 letters or numbers, stamped into the clay before firing.
- Personalization adds $8 per piece and 7 business days to the shipping time.
- Personalized items cannot be returned unless they arrive broken or the stamp has a mistake that we made.

Gift cards

- Digital gift cards from $25 to $200, sent by email on the date the buyer chooses.
- Gift cards never expire and can be used on several orders.
- Gift cards can't be exchanged for cash.

Wholesale and cafes

- Cafes and shops can order 24 or more pieces at wholesale prices.
- Wholesale orders take 4 to 6 weeks because every piece is made to order.
- For wholesale questions, the customer writes to wholesale@maplemugs.example. Don't quote wholesale prices in chat.

Contact and hours

- Email: help@maplemugs.example. The team answers within one business day.
- The studio is open to visitors on Saturdays from 10 am to 4 pm. No orders are packed on Saturdays.
- We don't have a phone line.

Things you must never do

- Never share another customer's name, address or order details.
- Never ask for card numbers or passwords.
- Never invent a discount code. The only current code is WELCOME10 (10% off a first order).
- Never guess. If you're not sure, say so and point the customer to help@maplemugs.example.